The History Department

YEAR 7 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of The History Portal pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time

Year 7 | Why did it take so long to clean up Britain?

🌀 **SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION)** CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

PUBLIC HEALTH & STATE POWER
Roman civic governance → Medieval municipal neglect → 1848 Public Health Act (L1, L2, L4)

SANITARY ENGINEERING & TECH
Roman aqueducts → Lead piping → Bazalgette's brick sewer network (L1, L6)

ETIOLOGY & SCIENTIFIC EMPIRICISM
Divine retribution & Miasma → John Snow's Broad St map → Germ Theory (L3, L5)

WORKING-CLASS ACTIVISM & RIGHTS
Polluted town riots → Water rate strikes → Public demand for health infrastructure (L2, L4)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 **How much progress did the Romans make in public health?** 🎯 CHANGE & CONTINUITY	• Describe the simple, practical sanitation methods used by Iron Age Britons. • Explain how Roman engineers introduced revolutionary sanitation technology. • Evaluate the significance of Roman bathhouses and latrines for public health. *Hinge Q: How did the Romans manage to keep the water flowing constantly into their forts?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Housesteads Fort Roman communal latrines (Hadrian's Wall); Seneca's moral treatise on Roman baths; Fishbourne Roman Palace mosaics ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Roman engineering triumphalism vs lived public health reality: lead piping & parasite transmission ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how the Romans tried to keep their towns clean.**

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 **Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?** 🎯 HISTORICAL EVIDENCE & MONASTIC LIFE	• Describe the simple cesspits used by peasants in rural Medieval villages. • Explain why Medieval monasteries built complex water systems. • Evaluate the role of gongfermers and night-work in medieval towns. *Hinge Q: Why were medieval drinking wells so dangerous?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Canterbury Cathedral Waterworks Plan (c. 1165); City of London Sanitary Ordinance of 1357; Monastic reredorter latrine architecture ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Medieval hygiene myths: Religious purity and monastic engineering vs urban municipal paralysis ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why public health in towns got worse during the Middle Ages.**
Lesson 3 **To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?** 🎯 CAUSATION & ETIOLOGICAL BELIEFS	• Describe the sanitation problems in growing Tudor and Stuart towns. • Explain why early flushing toilets like Sir John Harington's failed to catch on. • Evaluate how Samuel Pepys's diary reveals the reality of Early Modern sanitation. *Hinge Q: Why did the rivers in early modern towns become open sewers?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Sir John Harington's 1596 'Ajax' Toilet Diagram; Samuel Pepys' 1660 Diary on cellar privies; The Cowdray Engraving of Tudor Portsmouth (1545) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Laissez-faire policy debate & Roy Porter on early modern infrastructure limits; technological innovation vs municipal failure ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into how London authorities and medical practitioners attempted to control the 1665 Great Plague?**
Lesson 4 **How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?** 🎯 HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE & STATE INTERVENTION	• Describe the overcrowded and unhygienic conditions of industrial back-to-back housing. • Explain how Edwin Chadwick argued for public health reform in his 1842 report. • Evaluate Dr. John Snow's discovery that cholera was waterborne. *Hinge Q: Why did the rapid building of factories lead to a housing crisis?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Chadwick's 1842 Report on the Sanitary Condition of the Labouring Population; Dr John Snow's Broad Street Cholera Spot Map (1854); Portsmouth cholera burial registers ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Industrial urbanisation: Miasma theory vs early contagionist epidemiology; laissez-faire vs state health intervention ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into why Victorian medical authorities resisted John Snow's discovery that cholera was water-borne?**
Lesson 5 **Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets?** 🎯 SOURCE UTILITY & EPIDEMIOLOGICAL MAPPING	• Describe the events of the Great Stink in 1858. • Explain how Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system transformed London. • Evaluate how Louis Pasteur's Germ Theory revolutionized our understanding of disease. *Hinge Q: Why did Parliament suddenly care about public health in 1858?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Punch Cartoon 'The Silent Highwayman' (1858 Great Stink); Bazalgette's Victorian intercepting sewer blueprints (1859–1865); Eastney Beam Engine Pumping Station, Portsmouth: Civic Sanitation Masterpiece (1887) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** The Great Stink of 1858: Parliamentary self-interest and physical stench vs municipal laissez-faire ideology ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how Joseph Bazalgette's sewers improved public health in London.**
Lesson 6 **End of Unit Assessment: Cholera Investigation** 🎯 TURNING POINT ANALYSIS & CIVIL ENGINEERING	• Evaluate how Dr John Snow used map data and scientific deduction to prove cholera was waterborne in 1854. • Explain the shift from laissez-faire government attitudes to compulsory state intervention in British public health. • Produce a structured 8-mark explanation assessing the significance of Victorian sanitation reforms.	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Dr John Snow's 1854 Broad Street Cholera Spot Map; Soho mortality records & Eley Brothers percussion cap factory logs ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Snow's empirical epidemiological mapping vs the entrenched medical establishment and Board of Health ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **Explain the significance of John Snow's discovery during the 1854 Broad Street Cholera outbreak. (8 marks)**

Unit Key Vocabulary: Cholera • Miasma Theory • Laissez-Faire • Cesspit • Back-to-back housing • Public Health Act 1848 • Public Health Act 1875 • Broad Street Pump • The Great Stink • Sewage System • Edwin Chadwick • John Snow • Joseph Bazalgette • Industrial Revolution

Medieval England: 1066–1485

Year 7 | How was power won, maintained, and contested in Medieval England?

SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION) CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

MONARCHY, LAW & STATE POWER
Norman conquest autocracy → Royal justice & Clarendon → Magna Carta & Dynastic collapse (L1–L4, L8)

FEUDAL ECONOMY & MILITARY TECH
Motte-and-bailey engineering → Domesday land audit → Post-plague market economy (L1, L2, L5, L6)

CATHOLIC HEGEMONY & IDEOLOGY
Papal supremacy & Becket martyrdom → Doom paintings & tithes → Divine plague etiology (L3, L5, L6)

POPULAR & BARONIAL RESISTANCE
Saxon rebellions & Hereward → Runnymede baronial revolt → 1381 Peasants' March on London (L2, L4, L7)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 **1066 & The Battle of Hastings: Why did William win?** 🎯 CAUSATION & BATTLEFIELD TACTICS	• Assess the rival claims to the English throne in 1066. • Explain the tactical turning points of the Battle of Hastings. *Hinge Q: Hinge Question: If bloodline succession was not legally established in 1066, what gave a medieval claimant true legitimacy: election, oaths, or military force?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: The Bayeux Tapestry: Harold Swearing the Sacred Oath to William (c. 1070s); Source B: The Bayeux Tapestry: Death of King Harold & Flight of the Saxons (1066) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Explain why William of Normandy achieved victory at the Battle of Hastings in 1066. [12 marks] ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Explain why William of Normandy achieved victory at the Battle of Hastings in 1066. [12 marks]**
Lesson 2 **Castles, Terror & Domesday: How did the Normans subjugate England?** 🎯 HISTORICAL ANALYSIS: CONTROL & SUBJUGATION	• Explain how motte-and-bailey castles functioned as weapons of subjugation. • Analyse the significance of the Domesday audit in disinheriting the English. *Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Was a motte-and-bailey castle primarily a defensive shelter for knights, or an offensive weapon of terror designed to control the surrounding population?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: The Bayeux Tapestry: Normans Building a Castle at Hastings (1066); Source B: Great Domesday Book Folio: Survey of the King's Manors (1086) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Describe two features of Norman motte-and-bailey castles. [4 marks] ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Describe two features of Norman motte-and-bailey castles. [4 marks]**
Lesson 3 **Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?** 🎯 HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE & CHURCH-STATE CONFLICT	• Explain the conflict between Canon Law and royal courts over criminous clerks. • Analyse the causes and consequences of Becket's martyrdom. *Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Was Henry II trying to modernize the legal system, or was he attempting an authoritarian power grab over the Catholic Church?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Manuscript Illumination of King Henry II and Thomas Becket Clashing (c. 1300s); Source B: Eyewitness Account of the Murder of Thomas Becket by Edward Grim (1170) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Question 3(b) & 3(c): Contrasting Interpretations [8 marks • 10 mins] ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.**
Lesson 4 **Magna Carta (1215) & Medieval Kingship: Liberty or Barons' Power Grab?** 🎯 HISTORICAL INTERPRETATION: LIBERTY VS SELF-INTEREST	• Explain the financial and military pressures that pushed the barons into rebellion. • Evaluate the dual nature of Magna Carta: feudal self-interest versus constitutional legacy. *Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Was John an unusually evil king, or an unlucky administrator struggling to finance modern warfare on an outdated feudal budget?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Matthew Paris, Chronicle Portrait of King John (c. 1250); Source B: Magna Carta: Verbatim Clauses 39 and 40 (1215) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Write a narrative account analysing the key events leading from the loss of Normandy (1204) to the sealing of Magna Carta (1215). [8 marks] ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Write a narrative account analysing the key events leading from the loss of Normandy (1204) to the sealing of Magna Carta (1215). [8 marks]**

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 5 **The Black Death (1348) & The Peasants' Revolt (1381): How did plague and rebellion shatter feudalism?** 🎯 CAUSAL LINKS & SOCIO-ECONOMIC CHANGE	• Explain the economic chain reaction connecting the Black Death to the labour crisis. • Evaluate whether the Peasants' Revolt was a failure or long-term success. *Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why did the Black Death empower ordinary peasant workers when kings and bishops remained in power?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: The Statute of Labourers Parliamentary Statute Extract (1351); Source B: Jean Froissart: The Death of Wat Tyler at Smithfield (c. 1380s) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** 'The Black Death of 1348 was the main cause of the breakdown of the feudal system in medieval England.' How far do you agree? [12 marks] ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] 'The Black Death of 1348 was the main cause of the breakdown of the feudal system in medieval England.' How far do you agree? [12 marks]**